

EDUCATIONAL DISCOVERIES

February 27, 1992

Dr. W. Edwards Deming
4924 Butterworth Place
Washington, D.C. 20016

Dear Dr. Deming,

Your response to my letter opens my heart more than I imagined. I have already begun to reread your manuscript for *The New Economics*. I am giving considered and deep, creative thought to your invitation regarding the content of your four-day seminar that I recently attended in San Jose. My partner, Peg Doubleday, and I will plan to attend another one of the same with the explicit purpose of examining the specific areas where the application of our theory of transformation might be of benefit to the course.

As I contemplate why American business has not been able to truly understand and maintain the transformation your management system demands, I have some thoughts to share with you. I consider the Japanese mind as patient, used to cooperation and inwardly directed. The Japanese have a deep sense of family and the work place is experienced as an extension of that family where they can demonstrate their sense of order and loyalty. Whereas, the American consciousness tends to be competitive, approval oriented and outwardly directed. We tend to use fear and caution as a driving force for our decision making.

I believe that in order for American business to succeed in transforming our system of management, the leadership of each organization needs to demonstrate that people can change their beliefs about themselves and trust in each others' talents, skills and abilities. Workers need to be met with excitement, trust and openness, where management is willing to listen to each person's truth about the problems of the organization.

I just returned from a trip to Hawaii, where we have been consulting with Wilcox Memorial Hospital for the last year and a half. During that time, we have been working to transform the culture from competition and blame to one of personal responsibility. Our work was instituted in preparation for and as a complement to the implementation of your system of management. (The CEO and his administrative staff have been attending Quorum seminars as well as your own. And, as I mentioned in my first letter, John Dowd is beginning to bring your theory into the hospital itself.)

The CEO, housekeeping staff, nurses aides and dietary staff have been a pleasure to work with. Most of the employees, the "willing workers," have been open and vulnerable to new ideas. The executive level administrative staff, and many of the management staff on the other hand, tend to be threatened with the idea of Personal Responsibility and prefer to keep to their old paradigm while acting like they are changing paradigms.

We believe that this bind of form vs. essence that we are encountering at Wilcox is a key to why companies who try to implement your system are unable to accomplish the transformation that you are teaching. Do you think this is generally true? Have you found this to be a recurring theme?

One division of the hospital that is "transformed" in its approach to CQI is Long-Term Care. It is also the division that we have been working with the longest. In the division,

there is openness, the workers are treated with respect and trust, teams are working to continually improve procedures and to solve problems on an ongoing basis and there is a growing experience of joy and aliveness. We attribute this to the fact that the director of Long Term Care is truly embracing the transformation to personal responsibility "whole heartedly."

I, also have a great desire to spend time with you. I would like to do so as soon as possible. I am pleased and happy at the thought. I look forward to talking with you soon.

With best wishes,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, appearing to read "Judith", written in dark ink.

Judith Orloff-Falk

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January 23, 1992

W. Edwards Deming
New York University
Sterns School of Business
Stat/Or Dept. 10th Floor
90 Trinity Pl.
New York, NY 10006

Dear Dr. Deming;

I attended your seminar in San Jose last week, on January 14-17. I was very happy to learn your information directly from you. I have attended other seminars based on your material and I did not experience the essence of your purpose as clearly as I did last week.

I consult with Wilcox Memorial Hospital in Kauai, Hawaii, as does John Dowd. My role there is to transform the culture through working with the executive team. My particular experience and skill focuses on the same issues as your points of Driving out Fear and Constancy of Purpose in an organization.

I often discover that people in leadership positions would rather maintain their point of view than achieve success. My work centers around creating an environment of safety so that leaders in an organization will learn to listen to what others are telling them. Many people are afraid to hear something that threatens their illusions. And, hearing you teach about the workers' need for joy and internal motivation in work speaks directly to my heart and my company's purpose.

I am enclosing a copy of a book that my partner and I wrote. We believe it teaches people how to have internal motivation and joy in their lives. I would deeply appreciate it if you would read a chapter or two of "Choices for Success," particularly the sections on The Model for Change and Sources of Information. If the work in this book aligns and agrees with your work I would like to know. We believe that it does.

We have not been able to find an American publisher for our book. They say that there are so many books on the market like ours, etc., etc. I think that because they do not really understand what we are saying, they miss the point. If we could include positive comments from you, I know we would be able to have it published in America.

We have another book in process on business leadership. We believe that this book supports and complements your information to an even greater extent. It is derived from our work with CEO's and executive teams on how to demonstrate what you call Constancy of Purpose and how to eliminate fear from the workplace.

I am also enclosing a copy of a letter I wrote about paradigm shifts in business, that was published in Human Resource Executive .

I would like an opportunity to spend time with you and share our mutual love for the work that we do. Please consider this. Thank you for your time and for your contribution to human joy.

With Best Wishes,

Judith Orloff-Falk

Judith Orloff-Falk
Vice President

Enclosures

*Sent book
business card*